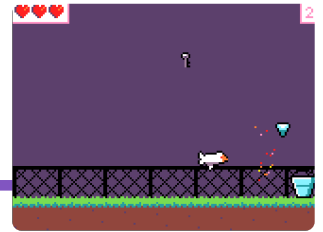


SWOOP — run sheet

Year 6 STEM Launchpad taster · MakeCode Arcade, blocks · 50 minutes · ~22 students, one laptop each



Before they arrive

- SWOOP preloaded on every laptop, and confirmed to **open straight into the Blocks view** — no URL typing, no import, no sign-in.
- Mission cards cut (one A4 sheet makes two cards). Missions 1–5 face down in a pile per bench; **the STUCK card stays face up** next to each laptop all session.
- Play it yourself once so you know what "too slow" feels like before they tell you.

Timing **PROPOSED — NOT YET AGREED**

TIME	#	BEAT	WHAT YOU'RE WATCHING FOR
0–5		Laptops open. Play it. No instructions.	Everyone gets a game running. Nobody is reading anything yet.
5–8		"You're not writing a game today. You're changing one."	Hand out Mission 1. Point at the toolbox once — colour, not names.
8–13	1	Make it yours	No logic at all. Everyone should finish. Watch for light skies — the crow is white.
13–20	2	Fix the difficulty	The real lesson: change → play → change. Push them to press ► between edits.
20–28	3	Win the season	First time they drag a new block out. Most common error: game over dropped <i>under</i> the pink block instead of inside it.
28–38	4	Add a second crow	Where most will finish. Right-click → Duplicate is the whole skill.
38–43	5	Your twist / catch-up	Early finishers go to Mission 5. Anyone behind stays on 3 or 4 — that's a complete game.
43–50		Playtest round, then email yourself the link	Swap seats, play a neighbour's. Then Share → email the link to themselves.

What each mission actually does — measured, not estimated

#	THE EDIT	WHAT CHANGES WHEN IT WORKS
—	Starter, untouched	A passive player loses their first life at 5–12 s and all three by 25–36 s. Competent play for 60 s scores about 20 — playable, but visibly slow.
1	Redraw the bucket; change the sky	Cosmetic only. Nothing can break. The game still runs on a white sky — the crow keeps a black outline — but dark skies look far better.
2	dropEvery 2500 → ~700, fallSpeed 15 → ~60	Score over 60 s goes from ~20 to ~54 — roughly 2.5× the catch rate . Felt immediately, which is the point.
3	Add on score 15 → game over WIN	Reaching 15 ends the game with "YOU WIN!". Verified on screen.
4	Duplicate the crow stack, retime it to 2000 ms	Score 42 in 60 s with 2 lives left — harder, still winnable. With Mission 3 also applied, a good player wins in about 16 s.
5	Sound on catch, bigger bucket, countdown, fifth loot item	All four compile and run.

The questions you will get

"My crow flies backwards."

They've sent a crow in from the right. The sprite only faces one way, so it moon-walks. It *works* — treat it as a good bug, not a fault. Fixing it properly means flipping every frame in the crow's animation, which is a real Mission 5 job.

"I set dropEvery to 0 and it went mad."

About 95 sprites on screen, score rockets, **no crash and no hang** — tested. Let it happen, then ask them what number would be silly-but-playable.

"Where do I draw the bucket?"

Click the *picture inside the block*, not the block. The drawing grid opens over the whole screen; the green **Done** button is bottom right.

"Nothing happened."

Nine times in ten the block is floating, not clicked on. Second most likely: they changed a number but didn't press ► again.

"Can I keep it?"

Share → email themselves the link. See the caveat below.

Known limits — read before the session

The school filter is untested. Three things have not been checked on a school laptop: that arcade.makecode.com loads at all, that the preloaded project opens, and that a student can *create* a share link. The third one decides whether the take-home works — worth testing on one laptop before the day rather than in front of 22 students.

No public share link has been published yet, so there is currently no URL to fall back on if a laptop hasn't been preloaded.

- **No music, by design.** Twenty-two laptops of chiptune is a wall of noise. Sound is a Mission 5 side quest, not a default — if it takes off, be ready to ask for headphones or a volume-down.
- **Missions 1–3 are the guaranteed core.** A student who finishes 3 has a complete, winnable game. Mission 4 is where most will end; Mission 5 is stretch and is deliberately unspecified.
- **Nothing a student does today can break the starter** beyond an undo. Every sloppy edit worth worrying about was tested: zero spawn interval, absurd fall speed, white sky. None crash.